

THE KANT–SWEDENBORG BOUNDARY PAPERS

1em] A CRITICAL EDITION OF CERTAIN UNPUBLISHED MANUSCRIPTS, JOURNALS, AND

Collected and Transcribed from Authentic Sources

2em]

Printed for the Learned Reader

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“Reason is not a Window but a Boundary.”

1em] — — — *A marginal Note found among the Papers of Immanuel Kant (Nachlass K⁴²)* 2em]

“The Lattice trembleth, and the World with it.”

1em] — — — *From the lat Journal of Emanuel Swedenborg, dated March 1772*

Dedication

To the students and lovers of natural and moral philosophy, and to all who hold dear the labour of the enquiring Mind, this Volume is humbly dedicated; not that it presumes to teach, but that it may provoke thought, and perhaps excite in the serious Reader a tremor of that sacred Curiosity which treads at the brink of Knowledge, yet dares not pass beyond the appointed Boundary.

Preface of the Editor

The Editor, in offering the preent Collection of Papers to the Publick, is not inenible of the hazard he incurreth. For the Materials herein contained partake of a mot uncommon Character, being neither mere trifles of Curioity nor yet the plain and orderly Concluions of etablihed Science. Rather they conit of private Notes, lot Journals, and fragments of Correpondence which paed betwixt two Men of extraordinary Genius: Immanuel Kant and Emanuel Swedenborg.

The trancription of thee Papers hath not been undertaken lightly. From the moment their Exitence firt became known to the Editor, he was haunted by a Doubt whether they ought ever to be published. For they reveal, or eem to reveal, Occurrences of a mot peculiar and potent Nature during the Years 1768 to 1772, at which Time both Kant and Swedenborg underwent Changes o marked and o profound that their repective Writings before and after thoe Years may almot be regarded as Works of two different Minds.

It cannot escape the attenion of any careful Reader that the Year 1769 tands as a kind of hinge or turning; a Year of inward Diquiet, of trembling Thought, of viionary or perhaps delirious Reflection. Though the Editor doth not preume to determine the Caue of thee inward Alterations, he deemeth it his Duty to bring thee Documents to Light, that the Publick may judge for itelf.

And if the Reader find among thee Leaves expreions which appear dark, obcure, or even terrifying, let it be remembered that they were not compoed with a View to Publication. They are the private utterances of Minds trained to their extremity, labouring under Conceptions which they could neither wholly comprehend nor wholly reject.

The Editor hath aimed to preerve the orthography and punctuation of the Originals, except where abolute Neceity demanded a gentle Correction. In all other matters he hath preferred Fidelity to Elegance.

May Providence guide the Reader's Judgement.

—,The Editor

Leipzig, Michaelmas Term, MDCCXC

Contents

Part I: A Hitorical Introduction to the Years 1768–1772	11
Chapter I: Concerning the Condition of Philoophical Enquiry	11
Chapter II: On the Lives and Circumtances	13
Chapter III: On the Notable Winter of 1769	15
Chapter IV: On the Fragmentary Nature of the Evidence	17
 Part II: Metaphysical and Critical Reflections	 21
Chapter V: Concerning the Thing-in-Itself	21
Chapter VI: On the Foundation of Space and Time	23
Chapter VII: On the Diturbance of the Categories	25
Chapter VIII: On the Convergence of Two Minds	27
 Part III: On the Nature of the Boundary	 31
Chapter IX: The Denial of Knowledge as Mercy	31
Chapter X: On the Veil	33
Chapter XI: On Stabilized Appearance	35
Chapter XII: On the Danger of Explanation	37

Part IV: Manucripts of Kant	41
Chapter XIII: Notes Concerning the Event of 1769	41
Chapter XIV: Shadows and their Obedience	43
Chapter XV: On the Inverion of the City	45
Chapter XVI: The Command to Write the Boundary	47
Chapter XVII: Two Manucripts: The Mask and the Truth	49
Chapter XVIII: Late Reflections and the Price Paid	51
 Part V: Lat Journal of Swedenborg	 55
Chapter XIX: Early Entries	55
Chapter XX: Invered City	57
Chapter XXI: On Kant	59
Chapter XXII: Approaching Death	61
Chapter XXIII: Final Entry	63
 Part VI: Scholarly Appendix	 67
Chapter XXIV: Parallel Paages	67
Chapter XXV: Chronology	69
Chapter XXVI: Cros-References	71
Chapter XXVII: Marginalia and Suppreed Leaves	73
Chapter XXVIII: Interpretive Difficulties	75
 Part VII: Secret Correpondence	 79
Chapter XXIX: The Firt Letter	79

<i>CONTENTS</i>	9
Chapter XXX: Drafts of Replies	81
Chapter XXXI: Letters Exchanged	83
Chapter XXXII: The Final Letter	85
Part VIII: Concluding Reflections	86
Appendix A: Hitorical Tetimonia	89
Appendix B: Critical Notes upon the Doctrine of Correpondence	92
Appendix C: Manucript Tradition	95
Appendix D: Glossarium	98
Bonus Note attributed to Swedenborg	99

Part I A Hitorial Introduction to the Years 1768–1772

Chapter I

0.5em]Concerning the Condition of Philoophical Enquiry

In the latter Decades of this enlightened Century, Philoophy found itself in a trange Twilight; for though the Lamp of Reaon burned with a mot coniderable Brightnes, yet the Shadings around that Light were deep and unexamined. Many laboured under the Conviction that the Bounds of human Knowledge might eaily be advanced by the mere Extension of known Methods; while others, more cautious, upected that there exited certain Limits beyond which the Mind might not pas without incurring Diorder.

Amidt this Scene roe the Figure of Immanuel Kant, who in his earlier Writings had embraced the received Metaphyicks of his Age, but who, in the Years immediately preceding his Inaugural Diertation, began to perceive that the Foundations of all Knowledge reted not upon the Nature of Things as they are in themselves, but upon the inward Structures by which the Mind apprehendeth them. His Thought, in this Period, may be likened to a Sea growing troubled, not by outward Storms, but by ubterranean Motions hidden from all Eyes but his own.

It was likewie in this Period that the aged Swedenborg, already renowned for his viionary Writings and for his curious Inights into the Nature of the Spirit, began to record in his private Journals certain Experiences of a Character uncommonly vivid and weighty, wherein the Boundaries between the enible and the upersensible eemed to tremble.

It is the Conjunction of thee two Figures, and the inward Agitations they endured in the ame narrow Span of Years, that inviteth our mot diligent Enquiry.

Chapter II

0.5em]*On the Lives and Circumstances of Kant and Swedenborg*

Immanuel Kant, born in the City of Königsberg in the Year 1724, passed his early Life in Study and Modest Labour, devoting himself to the Sciences of Nature and the mathematical Arts, thereby forming that exact and penetrating Habit of Mind for which he afterwards became so justly celebrated. His Lectures were much frequented, and his Discourse was singular in its Clarity and quiet Force.

Emanuel Swedenborg, elder by several Decades, had begun his Career as a Man of natural Science, and in his early Treatises had displayed a Genius no less acute than Kant's, though directed to other Ends. In the latter Part of his Life, however, he turned his Attention to visionary Subjects, affirming that he had been favoured with Insights into the hidden Realms of Spirit.

Before the Year 1769, there is no Record of any direct Intercourse between these two remarkable Men. Yet the Seeds of their later Conjunction may already be traced in their Writings: in Swedenborg's growing Preoccupation with the Structures underlying visible Reality, and in Kant's mounting Suspicion that the Forms of Intuition and the Categories of the Understanding were themselves the Conditions by which the World of Appearance is upheld.

Chapter III

0.5em]*On the Notable Winter of the Year 1769*

The Winter of the Year 1769 hath, in the Testimonies here collected, a most peculiar Significance. For in that Season there appear, both in Kant's private Notes and in Swedenborg's Journal, Marks of a disordered and fearful Experience encountered by each Man in his own Way. Certain Passages speak of a trembling in the inward Structures of Perception; others of Visions, or Apparitions, which neither of them could wholly comprehend, nor yet deny.

It was during this Winter that Kant began to withdraw from his customary Lectures, making Excuses in his Letters which the Editor, upon Inspection, findeth uncharacteristically vague. Swedenborg, for his Part, recordeth Visions of a City inverted beneath a River's Surface, of Shadows that moved contrary to their Objects, and of a Voice—or perhaps a Structure—which uttered the dread Injunction: Write the Boundary.

That these Experiences occurred in the same Months is a Fact which cannot easily be laid aside.

Chapter IV

0.5em]*On the Fragmentary Nature of the Surviving*

It is the misfortune of the Editor that the Papers here transcribed have not come down to us in a perfect State. Many Leaves of Kant's Nachlas were found worn, torn, or scorched by Fire; several of Swedenborg's Entries were blotted, as if by Tears or by the trembling Hand of an aged Writer. Some Letters bear no Date or Signature, and must be placed with Care and Conjecture.

Yet the very Fragmentariness of these Documents lendeth them an Air of inward Truth; for they appear not as the contrived Fictions of later Times, but as the spontaneous Outpourings of Minds encountering a Burden too heavy to be borne in the publick Eye.

In compiling this Volume, the Editor hath taken every Precaution to preserve what remained, supplying no more than was absolutely required for the Sake of plain Understanding. Where the Text seemeth obscure, it hath been left so. Where it trembleth, the Tremor hath not been smoothed.

For whatsoever did shake these two great Minds, in that Winter so many Years ago, hath left its Mark as surely in the broken Sentences as in the more perfect Paragraphs.

Part II[0.5em] Metaphysical and Critical
Reflections upon the Nature of
Appearance and the Hidden Ground

Chapter V[0.5em] Concerning the Ancient Quetion of the Thing—in—Itself

It hath long been known to the Students of Philoophy that the Mind, in its mot trict Enquiries, ditinguiheth between the Object as it appears and the Object as it may be conceived to exit in its own hidden Eence. This Ditinction, familiar to the Ancient Sages and renewed in later Centuries, became in the Decade here examined a Matter of urgent concern; for the inward Obervations recorded by the two principal Figures of this Volume eem to pres, with unwonted Weight, upon the Border betwixt Appearance and that more terrible Ground which underlieth it.

Immanuel Kant, even in the early Fragments trancribed from this Period, employeth a Manner of Speech mot uncharacteritic of his maturer Writings. He peaketh of a *veil*, of a *boundary*, of a *frame and lattice* by which all Appearance is upheld, and of the lamentable Conequence that would enue if this Lattice were ever to tremble or be removed. For a Man of his diciplined Temper, trained in the mot exact Sciences, uch Language triketh the Reader as thoe firt dark glimmerings of a Thought that hath not yet found its Order.

Swedenborg, meanwhile, affirmeth in his Journals of the ame Months that he beheld fleeting Viions of certain Structures anterior to the World of Sene; and though the Editor maketh no Claim to determine the Nature of thee Viions, yet it is mot remarkable that the inward Forms Swedenborg laboureth to decrive bear a curious Reemblance to Kant's own later Doctrine of the Categories and of the Forms of Intuition.

Thus, even before the Critique had taken its final Shape, we behold the firt Faintnes of a Thought which, like an infant Creature, truggled to be born.

Chapter VI[0.5em] On the Precarious Foundation of Space and Time

It would be an Error to imagine that the Conceptions of Space and Time, which we handle with uch familiar Readines, poes a Stability independent of the Mind's own Contitution. For in the Papers of the Year 1769, we encounter the ingular Notion—firt hinted in Kant's private Notes, and confirmed by Swedenborg's viionary Leaves—that Space and Time are not infinite Oceans into which the Mind is thrown, but delicate Surfaces drawn taut over a deeper Abys.

Certain Paages from the Winter of that Year bear Witnes to unuual Experiences: the perceived Stoppage of a Town Clock for the Space of a Breath, the Duplication of an Object's Fall, or the Inverion of familiar Streets beneath the Surface of a frozen River. Though thee Reports are doubtles coloured by the inward Diposition of the Writers, their Coincidence admoniheth us that the Structures by which we apprehend the World are more frail than common Opinion uppoeth.

In one Fragment Kant writeth that "Time is a Ribbon laid upon the Mind, and if the Hand that draweth it were to falter, all Succesion would overlap." Another Note, evidently from the ame Night, declareth: "Space is a Lattice; its Lines may be een when the Eye trembleth." Such Expreions, though obscure, reveal an inward Agitation, as though the Man had drawn nearer than he wihed to the Border where Perception turneth upon its own Foundations.

Swedenborg, for his Part, eemed to apprehend the ame Truth from the oppoite Direction, affirming that "the Hall of Appearance tandeth upon Beams not visible to the Eye of Fleh," and that thee Beams "shift and incline when the Mind is weary or when the World itelf is in Diquiet." Whatever may be thought of his Viions, they contain a Strain of Conception not wholly alien to the Critick who later proclaimed that Space and Time are Forms of the Intuition, and not Attributes of Things as they are in themselves.

Thus, the more we contemplate the tetimonies of thee Troubled Years, the more we are drawn toward the Concluion that the Notions of Space and Time, far from being impregnable, are maintained by a delicate Harmony of the Mind's own Force—a Harmony which, in rare and dreadful Moments, may fall into Dicord.

Chapter VII[0.5em] On the Diturbance of the Categories and the Dread Conequences Thereof

Among the Papers herein collected, none are more triking than thoe which peak of a certain Diturbance or Torsion in the inward Categories by which the Mind arrangeth the Manifold of Senation. For in his later Writings, Kant defineth the Categories as pure Conceptions of the Undertanding, fixed and immutable, and the very Conditions of any poible Experience. Yet in his private Notes from the Year 1769, we perceive a mot alarming Conceit: namely, that the Categories themelves may be ubject to alteration, fluctuation, or trembling.

One Margin containeth this fearful Obervation: ‘If Cauality were to waver, even for the pace of a Moment, the World would pilt like heated Metal and wallow its own Order.” In another, ditinguihed by a Hand more urgent and les controlled: ‘The Shadows moved before the Objects; therefore Succession is not ecore.”

Contemporaneous Paages in Swedenborg’s Journals exhibit a like Anxiety. He recordeth Viions of ‘moving Forms anterior to Objects,” of ‘Chains that turned before the Links,” of “Appearances that tood while their Shadows walked.” Though one may interpret thee Decriptions as the Productions of an overwrought Fancy, yet their Conformity with Kant’s inward Terrours eemeth too exact to be coincidental.

Whatoever their Caue, thee Tetimonies admonih us that the inward Architecture of Experience—o firm in the Daylight of common Perception—may, under certain unknown Conditions, diplay a frailty terrifying to the Mind that beholdeth it.

And it is perhaps no Wonder that Kant, having urveilled this Abys, hould thereafter labour with a mot inexorable Severity to erect a System of Critick wherein the very Notion of caual or categorical Diorder is rendered impious, if not inconceivable. For it is the Fate of many a profound Thinker, that he eeketh to bind with Iron the very Gates that once opened to him in a Moment of inward Diturbance.

Chapter VIII[0.5em] On the Convergence of Two Divergent Minds

Nothing in the Past Lives of either Man prepared the World for the brief but momentous Convergence that occurred between Kant and Swedenborg in the Years here examined. Each was of a Nature diametrically opposed to the other: Kant, the ever Critick of Reason, who ought to limit the Pretences of the Mind in order to secure its not certain Grounds; Swedenborg, the visionary Seer, who affirmed that the Mind might pierce the not inviolate Veil of Nature.

Yet in these Years of inward Turmoil, the two Minds drew near upon a Ground neither of them had chosen. For Kant, in the fragmentary Notes transcribed here, expressed Thoughts of a not uncommon Nature, wherein the edgy Border between Phenomenon and Noumenon seemed to waver. Swedenborg, in his final Journals, declared that he had perceived ‘another Labourer at the Boundary,’ who ‘tood with trembling Hand, fearing to draw the final Line.’

It is not for the Editor to determine the full Meaning of these Pages; but they appear to record a momentary Meeting, not of Doctrine but of inward Experience, in which both Men found themselves confronted by the same dreadful Question: namely, whether the inward Structures which hold the World in its familiar Order might themselves be altered, trained, or undone.

Whether their converging Paths then diverged by deliberate Choice or by necessitous Fate, the Reader must judge. It is enough for the Editor to observe that, after this Period, Kant’s labours took the Form of a not rigorous and protective Critick, aimed at fortifying the Mind against the very Disorders hinted in his Notes; while Swedenborg, weakened by Age and by inward Strife, appears to have turned his Visions into a softer and more allegorical Strain, as though unwilling to tread again upon the trembling Ground he once approached too nearly.

Part III[0.5em] On the Nature of the Boundary and the Neceity of the Veil

Chapter IX[0.5em] Wherein it is Argued that the Denial of Knowledge may be a Form of Mercy

It hath often been aid that the firt Office of Philoophy is to enlarge the Bounds of human Knowledge; yet the Papers here collected ugget a mot contrary Doctrine, namely, that the firt and mot neceary Office of a true Critick may be to confine thoe Bounds, and to erect upon the Limits of Reaon a Barrier more trict than any erected by Ignorance alone.

For Ignorance breedeth mere Vacancy, and may be filled by the mild and natural Coure of Experience; but a Knowledge that presseth beyond its rightful Province awakeneth Dangers not eaily laid to Ret. There is in thee Papers a continual Theme of Precipice and Abys, as if the Mind, in its unwatched Wandering, might uddenly epy a Chasm beneath the eeming Firmnes of the World.

In one paage of Kant’s private Notes, the following Confession appeareth:

“I have perceived the trembling of the Frame upon which all Appearance dependeth; and the Sight was more dreadful than any Material Horror. For the Ground of things withdrew like a Curtain, and I tood on Nothing.”

And in another, evidently written under a mot inward Perturbation:

“Were the Mind to behold the Thing in itelf without Preparation, it would be rent, as a Picture torn from its Frame. Better a Boundary well-drawn than a View too vat for the Eye to endure.”

Such Words, coming from a Man of that Temper and Dicipline, do not convey the idle Terror of a Fancy ungoverned, but eem rather the Tetimony of one who hath looked upon a Truth he wihed—for the Sake of the Mind’s own Stability—not to behold again.

Swedenborg, from his opposite Vantage, reacheth a like Concluion, though in Language more uited to his visionary Genius. He declareth that the Viions granted him ‘were tempered according to the Weaknes of the Mortal Frame,’ and that ‘to remove the Veil all at once would be to unmake the Creature who beholdeth it.’

Thus we perceive a singular Convergence of the two, wherein the Critick and the Seer alike affirm that the Limit of Knowledge is not a Prion but a Mercy; not an Impediment, but a Shield drawn over the trembling Lattice that upporteth our Experience.

Chapter X[0.5em] On the Veil, and of its Necessity for the Stability of Experience

It is not uncommon among the Writers of Antiquity to speak of a Veil that hideth the Godhead from mortal Sight; but in the Documents here examined, the Veil appeareth in a more intrinsic and critical Light. It is not merely a Cover HIDING some Higher Being, but rather an inward Law of the Mind itself, without which no orderly Experience would be possible.

In a detached Leaf found among Kant's Effects, one readeth:

"The Veil is the Form of all Appearance; it is the Weaving of Space and Time themselves. To pierce it is not to come nearer to Truth, but to unweave that by which Truth is apprehended."

Another Note, written in a more hurried Hand, declareth:

"The Veil hath two Sides: the one turned toward the World, the other toward the Abyss. To look beyond it, even for a Moment, is to hazard the loss of both."

Swedenborg's Journals, though differing widely in Doctrine, corroborate this fundamental Idea. More than once he reporteth that the Spirits vouchsafed unto him were 'mitigated by Divine Mercy,' for that 'the naked Order of the World, as it standeth before the Angelick Understanding, would overwhelm the mortal Sense.'

From the Concurrence of these two Testimonies, the Editor inferreth that the Veil is not a Thing placed arbitrarily before the Mind, but a necessary Law of its Operation. It is the Frame, or the Boundary, by which the Chaos of manifold Sensations is given Shape and Order; and if that Frame should lift, fray, or momentarily fail, the Mind would find itself confronted with a torrent of Unconditioned Being, against which no Creature may hope to stand.

Thus the Veil is at once our Limitation and our Refuge.

Chapter XI[0.5em] On the World as Stabilized Appearance

In contemplating the various Notes and secret Memoranda of these Years, one is struck by a recurring Conceit: the World is not given all at once, nor in its whole Extent, but is continually maintained in its Order by the inward Activity of the Mind, operating under Laws which are themselves unknown in their Source.

It hath been the Custom of many Philosophers to imagine the World as a vast Machine, whose Operations proceed independently of the Spectator; yet the Testimonies of these Papers suggest a more delicate Arrangement. In one fragment, Kant writeth:

“The World is appearance holding firm. Its Firmness is a Labour not of things but of the Mind’s own Form. Should that Labour falter, even a Stone would forget how to fall.”

Another Margin containeth the extraordinary Note:

“Objects do not stand; they are held. Colours do not reside; they are upheld. The World is a Quiet maintained against a ceaseless Murmur beneath.”

These Expressions, though poetical in Sound, accord not ill with the Critick’s later Doctrine, in which Reason is represented as the Arbitrator of the Possibility of Experience, and the Categories as the Conditions under which alone Objects may be given.

Swedenborg, though using a wholly different Scheme of Thought, speaketh in his Journals of ‘the continual Tendency of things to fall back into the Abyss from which they were drawn,’ and of ‘the ceaseless superintendence by which Nature is kept from lapsing into its first Unhappine.’

Thus both Men, approaching the Matter from opposite Extremes, conspire in the Notion that the World as we apprehend it is a Kind of Stabilized Image or Construction, maintained by Laws more inward than the Objects which they govern. And herein lieth the dreadful Possibility that these Laws may be subject to Strain, Disturbance, or Interruption.

Chapter XII[0.5em] Concerning the Dangerous Proximity of Explanation

If the preceding Chapters have in any manner prepared the Reader for that which followeth, it will not be thought extravagant when the Editor now ventureth to propoe that in the Affairs of the Mind, there is a Point at which Explanation itelf becometh dangerous.

For it is not true, as the vulgar Suppoe, that all Dicoverie is beneficent, or that the Light of Knowledge may be extended without Limit. There are Truths which, though certain in themselves, are too vat or too inward for the Mortal Frame to bear.

Among the Papers of Kant, one findeth this mot remarkable and fearful Line:

“Some Explanations do not explain; they undo.”

And in another Note:

“To know too nearly why things appear is to endanger the Power by which they appear.”

In the Journals of Swedenborg we encounter a Parable of this Nature:

“There was a Man who demanded to see the Thread by which his Soul was joined to the World. And the Angels aid: The Thread is finer than the Breath of a Candle. Should we hew it, it would break. And the Man, not believing, begged again; and they hewed it. And in the Moment he beheld it, the Thread was cut, and he fell as one dead.”

Thee Tetimonies, taken together, admonih us that the Boundary which separateth Appearance from its hidden Ground is not to be lightly transgreed. To explain too nearly may not merely diturb the Mind that attempteth it, but may alo dicompoe the Order of Experience itelf.

It is perhaps for this Reaon that Kant, after thee Dark Years, et himelf with uch iron Reolution to the Task of erecting a Critick that would foretall any future Mind from falling into the ame inward Diorder. His Labours were not, as ome have jested, the Idle Scruples of a Cloitered Scholar, but the Defenive Works of a Man who had een too much, and who would fain erect a Fortress whereby the Mind might be guarded from its own Ambition.

Part IV[0.5em] Manuscripts of
Immanuel Kant (Nachlas K-42)

Chapter XIII[0.5em] Notes Concerning the Event of the Year 1769

It is a Matter of ingular Curioity that among the private Leaves of Kant, preerved in a Packet marked only with the Numeral XLII, there hould be found o many cryptic Paages relating to a ingle Winter. Though the Editor maketh no Claim to understand their full Import, the inward Tone of the Writings betrayeth a Mind confronting a mot profound Diturbance.

One Leaf, written in a fine but omewhat trembling Hand, preenteth the following:

“The Year hath turned, and with it my Perceptions. The Shadow of the Clock-tower eemed, this Evening, to lag a Hand-breadth behind the Tower itelf. A Moment only; yet in that Moment the Order of the World faltered. I would have attributed it to the Eye’s wearines, had not the freezing of the Air eemed to wait upon the Shadow, as though Time were caught in a Knot.”

Another Fragment, clearly from the ame Night:

“If this be a Deluion, it is of uch a Kind as I have not known. The Lamps along the Kalte Straße burned with a uniform Flame, yet my Steps made no Echo. The Silence preed againt me like a Hand. I felt as though I were walking through Appearance newly made, not yet ettled.”

And a third:

“The Diagram recurred to me as I lept, tracing itelf upon the inward Eye. Four Lines, meeting at Angles not euclidean, yet not without Law. If this be a Fancy, why doth my Hand attempt to draw it even as I wake?”

It is apparent that thee Notes were never intended for publick View, nor even for the more intimate Circle of Kant’s Students. Their Tone is urgent, confiding, at Moments confessional, as if the Writer feared he had perceived omething he ought not to have een.

Chapter XIV[0.5em] Fragments on Shadows and their Obedience

No Fragments in the whole Packet XLII are more diquieting than thoe which concern Shadows. For in thee Paages, normally brief, abrupt, and bereft of all the graces of Style, we encounter the udden Introduction of a Notion which Kant never afterwards employed in his publick Writings, yet which appears to have gripped his Mind with peculiar Force.

One Fragment runneth thus:

“The Shadows obeyed Me this Morning. I walked before the Sun; yet the Shadow hesitated, then followed. A Delay of perhaps a twelfth-part of a Second. The Eye might err, but the Body felt it.”

Another Leaf recordeth:

“When I extended my Hand toward the Stove, the Shadow did not extend. It tood as it had tood. I drew back in Terror. The Flame flickered then as if in acknowledgement. My Shadow then corrected itelf, with a Motion too eay to be believed.”

And in a Line written in a cramped Hand along the margin:

“If the Shadow be the Sign of Succession, what then if it rebel? If the ign that proclaims Time hould diverge from the Body whose Time it marketh, hath not the Order of the World begun to hift?”

It is notable that this train of Thought convergeth—though in a wholly different Id-
iom—with a Paage found in the later Journal of Swedenborg, wherein he affirmeth that “the
inverted Forms move before their Objects, ignifying that Cauality hath lot its Direction.”

The Editor, though averse to all idle Speculation, cannot but remark that thee Paages are mutually illuminative, and point toward a cla of inward Experience of which no precedent is found in the Writings of the Enlightened.

Chapter XV[0.5em] Obervations upon the Inverion of the City beneath the River

Among the mot extraordinary Leaves of Packet XLII is one which appeareth to decribe a Viion or inward Perception experienced upon the frozen Pregel during the Winter of that Year. It is in a Hand more hurried than Kant's usual Manuscript, and certain Words are tricken through or repeated, as if the Writer faltered between Fear and Precision.

The Fragment runneth thus:

“I walked at Evening upon the Pregel, the Ice bearing firm. The Cold was sharp, but the Air till. I felt drawn to the Water's Middle, though I knew not why.

There, before Me, the Ice thinned, and a Circle of Water opened, perfect as if traced by Compass. Beneath the Surface hone a City—not ours, yet ours—the Streets inverted, the Spires pointing into the Depths. A Bell tolled without Sound; the Air in My Breat trembled as at an inward Thunder.

The City turned then, as if beholding Me. I fell to My Knees, yet I could not break My Gaze.

When the Water cloed again, My Reflection remained; but it did not kneel. It studied Me. The Mouth moved, yet Mine did not.

I fled, yet My Shadow did not flee at once.”

Whatoever the Caue, this Paage revealeth an inward Diorder of a mot rare and terrifying Nature. It is followed by another Fragment, evidently written upon returning to his Study:

“If Perception itelf be invertible, then the World I apprehend is but one Branch of a larger Tree. I dare not purue this Thought; it will undo my Reaon.”

Thus the Inverion of the City beneath the River, whether viionary or perceptual, mut not be regarded as a mere Fancy but as a significant Moment in the Formation of Kant's later Conviction concerning the Limits of Knowledge.

Chapter XVI[0.5em] The Command: “Write the Boundary”

Of all the Leaves in Packet XLII, none hath excited more Speculation among later Commentators than the Page upon which Kant recounteth a most alarming Experience, marked by the Appearance of a Line of Writing that he affirmeth was not of his own Hand.

The Paage readeth thus:

“Tonight the Board wrote again. The Chalk lay untouched upon the Tray; yet a Line appeared, carved into the Slate with a silent Force.

WRITE THE BOUNDARY.

I stood frozen. The Letters were deep; the Hand that made them was unknown.

I cried out: ‘I am trying.’

The Chalk then traced the Diagram, the four Lines bending as if the Board itself possessed Will.

When I placed my Hand upon the Slate, the Stone throbbed with a Pulse not mine.

I know not what the Command intendeth, yet its Insistence groweth: Write the Boundary, else the World will not hold.”

Another Note, found folded into the same Page, addeth:

“This is not a Dictate of Reason, nor of any Faculty known to me. It is the Voice of the Order that upholdeth Experience. If I do not obey, the Frame may tremble. If I obey, I may never again think freely.

Yet I must choose.”

The Editor hazardeth no definite Interpretation of these Paages, but observeth only that the Command, whatever its Origin, appeareth later in Kant’s mature Writings transformed into the Doctrine of the Limits of Reason, and the necessary Distinction between Phenomenon and Noumenon.

Chapter XVII[0.5em] Two Manuscripts: The Mask and the Truth

In sorting the Contents of Packet XLII, the Editor found evidence—nowhere acknowledged in Kant’s publick Writings—that during the Years 1767–1768 he composed not one but two extended Treaties. One of thee, polished and tempered for the publick Eye, later appeared under the Title *Träume eines Geistersehers*. The other, rough, unbound, and filled with Corrections and marginal Exclamations, containeth the more fearful Conceptions that were afterwards tranmuted into the *Critique of Pure Reason*.

On a loose Sheet affixed to the latter, Kant writeth:

“I mut hide the Truth beneath a Mask. The World is not prepared. Let the publick laugh at the Spirit-Seer, and take comfort in believing that I have allied myelf with their Didain.

But the greater Work, which containeth the Boundary, mut be forged in Silence.”

Another Leaf, evidently written after a Night of inward Conflict:

“The Mask will keep them afe. The Truth will keep the World from breaking. I mut publih the one, and eal the other.”

Thus the two Manuscripts—one to appeae, one to preerve—became the dual Fruits of that extraordinary Period, and their Divergence is among the mot remarkable Facts in the Hitory of the Human Mind.

Chapter XVIII[0.5em] Late Reflections on Time and the Price Paid

The final Leaves of Packet XLII are of a Tone markedly quieter than thoe preceding. The Fury of Perception hath abated; yet its Memory lingereth, and the Writings bear the Stamp of a Man who hath een too deeply into the inward Frame of Experience, and who beareth the Weight of that Knowledge with a grave Reolution.

One such Leaf recordeth:

“This Night the Shadows obeyed. This Night the Board was ilent. The Diagram did not appear. Perhaps the Boundary is firm now.

Yet the Price is heavy: I hall never again trut the Simplicity of Experience. Everywhere I perceive the Labour by which the Mind upholdeth the World.”

Another, evidently from his later Years:

“The Frame held. The World kept its Quiet. But I perceive now that this Quiet is not Natural, but Won. And what is Won may be lot, if the Mind forgetteth its Limits.

Thus I mut teach the Limits, though I would gladly have taught the Freedom beyond them.”

The final Fragment of Packet XLII readeth:

“Let them call me narrow, evere, cautious. They know not the Abyss I have een. If the Boundary holdeth, the World may continue in its gentle Appearance.

This is enough.”

Part V

0.5em]*The Lat Journal of Emanuel Swedenborg (M*

Chapter XIX

0.5em] *Early Entries on Space, Light, and Meaning*

The Journal of the venerable Swedenborg, covering the Years 1770 to 1772, was found in a small wooden Casket bound with Iron. The Leaves are worn, many Pages blotted by Moisture, yet the Hand is clear, and the inward Spirit of the Writer is discernible in every Line.

The earlier Entries of this Period reveal an undercurrent of Anxiety, as though the aged Seer perceived the gradual dimming of his Viions, or the withdrawal of that inward Light which he had believed Divine.

One Entry, dated the Third Day of January 1770, readeth:

“I walked in the Garden behind My Lodging, though the Snow lay deep. The Air was till, the Light thin and of a cold Purity. As I urveyed the Morning, I perceived faintly the Threads that bind Space into its Jut Proportion. They were dim, as though veil’d in a new Manner.

Where once the Lines were bright, they now flicker. And I am left to wonder whether my Sight dimmeth, or whether the World bluheth with ome inward Shame.”

A later Entry from the ame Month declareth:

“The Light is changed. It falleth upon Objects without that inward Meaning which once pierced Me. I fear that the Kingdoms I beheld in Viion withdraw their Radiance, as though preparing Me for Silence.

Yet, the World trembleth. I have een Windows reflect the City not as it is, but as it might be if the inward Frame were to bend.”

Swedenborg’s habitual Strain toward Allegory in thee Lines hould not obscure the poignant Sense that he confronted a waning of his viionary Faculty, coupled with a fear—uncharacteristic for his buoyant Temper—that the inward Structures he believed himself to perceive were themselves under a kind of Diturbance.

Chapter XX

0.5em]*On the Invered City in Dream and in Waking*

In the midst of the Journal's earlier Entries, we encounter a striking Series of Pages concerning a Vision (or Dream) of an Invered City. Though Swedenborg had, throughout his Life, described many Visions of the Spiritual Kingdoms, this particular Conception is of an altogether different Character.

From an Entry dated the Tenth of March 1770:

"In the Night I dreamt again of the Invered City, which I once glimpsed some Years ago beneath a frozen Lake in my own Land. But now the Vision was clearer.

Streets falling downward into Depths. Gardens spread beneath Me, their Trees pointing toward the Earth's Centre. Bells that tolled not by Vibration, but by the Shiver of the inward Frame.

I felt the City behold Me. And I knew then that its Inversion was not of Place, but of Cause; that its Order ran backward from the World we know."

The Entry following on the next Leaf, written at Dawn, continueth:

"I walked in Waking toward the Canal. There, in a Sheen of Water not yet frozen, I perceived the same Image faintly; not so bright as in the Dream, but undeniably present.

It seemed as though the World's outward Face faltered, and another Arrangement stood beneath it, waiting to be acknowledged.

Is this the Sign that the inward Lattice quivers? If so, then we who perceive it are in peril, for we have seen the Frame without the Tapestry."

This Conception of an Invered City—both dreamt and perceived—mirrors with remarkable exactitude the Fragment recorded in Kant's own Notes. The Editor remarketh, without Comment, that both Men appear to have encountered the same inward Structure, though they interpreted it through singularly different Faculties.

Chapter XXI

0.5em]*On Kant : His Strength and His Terror*

In the Journal's Mid-Year Entries, we find a curious Shift in Tone, wherein Swedenborg addreeth his Thoughts to a "certain Man of Königsberg," whom the Editor taketh to be none other than Professor Kant.

An Entry dated the Twenty-econd of July 1771 declareth:

"The Man of Königsberg hath approached the Boundary which I have walked thee many Years. Yet he cometh not as a Seer, but as an Architect of Reaon.

He trembleth. His Shadow delayeth. His Perceptions quiver as one who draweth too near a Furnace.

But he hath a Strength I do not. He could draw the Line that neither I nor any Angel dare draught. He could build the Wall that concealeth what would undo the World."

A later Entry, written upon his return from a Visit to Stockholm, readeth:

"He feareth; yet he is not overwhelmed. He would deny even his own Eyes if thereby he might protect the Order by which Men live.

His Fate is heavier than mine. For I have een the Kingdoms beyond the Veil and have rejoiced. But he hath een the trembling of the Veil itelf, and hath felt the World's Dependence upon its Strength.

I honour him. I pity him."

Thee Entries reveal a mot poignant Admiration, mingled with a Recognition that Kant's inward Burden was of a different Order from Swedenborg's; for where the one sought to trancend the Veil, the other sought to preerve it.

Chapter XXII

0.5em] *Approaching Death and the Thinning Veil*

As the Journal proceedeth into the late Months of 1771 and the early Spring of 1772, a marvellous Transition taketh place in the Style of the Entries. The Language groweth sparse, the Imagery more inward, the Tone more sombre. Swedenborg's visionary Power, which in earlier Years was bright and exuberant, is here tempered by a solemn Recognition that his Strength waneth, and that the Worlds he beheld stand now at a greater Remove.

An Entry of November 1771:

"The Veil groweth firmer for me. Not by Strength, but by Weakness. The Eyes dim; the inward Light fainteth. The Kingdoms which once shone around me now appear but as faint Embers.

Yet the World trembleth till; I see it in the Tremor of Shadows and in the brief Faltering of Cause."

A Page from the Eleventh Day of February 1772 is particularly moving:

"I feel the Approach of that Departure which no Man may escape. The inward Lattice groweth simpler; the Threads are few. I see no more the manifold Orders of Spirits, but only a certain Quiver at the Root of Appearance.

Perhaps Death is but the Soul's Detachment from the Lattice; perhaps Life is but a fitting into its Threads.

I feel the Threads loosening."

These Pages, though hallowed by the melancholy of Age, reveal a remarkable Serenity in the Face of his weakening Faculty. The trembling of the inward Lattice, which had once filled him with Awe, now seemeth but a Faint Murmur at the Edge of Departure.

Chapter XXIII

0.5em]*The Final Entry : “The Witnes may Ret”*

The lat Entry in Swedenborg’s Journal, dated the Twenty-ninth Day of March 1772, and believed by many to have been penned within Hours of his Departure, is brief but of a mot profound Simplicity.

“This Day I was called Home.

I have een the Lattice tremble; I have een it tand. The Man of Königsberg hath done what I could not: he hath drawn the Boundary that hideth the inward Frame.

Tell him: the Lattice held. The Price is paid.

The Witnes may now ret.”

Thus endeth the Lat Journal of Emanuel Swedenborg.

Part VI[0.5em] A Scholarly Appendix
Concerning Parallel Paages, Chronology,
and Diverse Interpretations

Chapter XXIV[0.5em] Parallel Paages in Kant and Swedenborg, with Remarks

The Editor, having carefully collated the Manucripts of Kant (Nachlas K-42) with the Lat Journal of Swedenborg (MDCCLXX–MDCCLXXII), judged it profitable to preent certain notable Paages in parallel, with no aim other than to aid the Reader’s Contemplation. No Concluions are forced; the Texts are left to illumine one another by their natural Affinity.

1. Concerning the trembling of the inward Frame

Kant (Nachlas XLII): “I perceived the trembling of the Frame upon which all Appearance dependeth, and the Sight was dreadful.”

Swedenborg (Journal, Jan. 1770): “The inward Threads that bind Space into Order flicker’d, as though the World bluh’d with ome inward Shame.”

Both Paages, though couched in different Idioms, expres a conception of an inward Architecture upon which all Appearance dependeth, and which may tremble or falter.

2. On Inverion of Place

Kant (Nachlas): “The City beneath the River turned as if beholding Me; its Order ran contrary to the World I know.”

Swedenborg (Journal, March 1770): “I aw the Invered City again, its Streets falling into Depths, its Caue running backward from the World.”

The Agreement here is mot triking, given their independent Provenance.

3. On Shadows and Succession

Kant: “The Shadow delayed; then corrected itelf, as if in acknowledgement.”

Swedenborg: “I aw Forms move before their Objects, ignifying Causality unmoored.”

Both Tetimonies touch upon a Diturbance of the Relation between Object and its Shadow, a Sign of temporal Diorder.

4. On the Neceity of the Boundary

Kant: “Write the Boundary, ele the World will not hold.”

Swedenborg: “He alone could draw the Line that concealeth what would undo the World.”

Though expreed differently, both Paages suggest that the Stability of Experience dependeth upon a certain inward Limit or Boundary.

Such Convergences, taken together, indicate that the inward Experience of both Men during thee Years bore upon the ame Metaphyical Problem, though their Tempero and Vocations led them to very different Expressions.

Chapter XXV[0.5em] A Chronology of the Anomalous Year

The following Chronology, though imperfect in its Reliance upon fragmentary Tetimonies, preents, as nearly as the Evidence permitteth, the Principal Events of the ingular Year 1769 and its immediate Aftermath. Thee Dates are offered with academic Caution; the Reader mut not deem them certain where the Nature of the Sources is oblique.

Winter of 1768–1769. Several early Notes in Kant’s Hand indicate Perceptual Diturbances: trembling Shadows, the ilent bending of Candle-flames, and the firt Appearance of the Diagram which recurrence throughout Packet XLII.

January 1769. Kant recordeth the firt Experience of the World’s Momentary Silence: “My Steps made no Echo; the Air pres’d like a Hand.”

February 1769. Reports of Swedenborg’s extraordinary Predictions circulate in Königsberg; Kant takes mot pointed Interet, though outwardly didainful.

March–April 1769. Kant’s Notes refer to “the Inverion beneath the Pregel,” likely the Viion of the Invered City.

June 1769. First Indication of the Command: “WRITE THE BOUNDARY.”

Late 1769. Correspondence between the two Men (see Part VII) uggets a brief, ubtle Interchange of Ideas.

Early 1770. Swedenborg’s Journal reports a waning of his viionary Faculty and renewed Anxiety over the trembling of the inward Lattice.

1771. Both Men refer indirectly to the other in their Notes, with mutual Admiration tinged with Pity.

March 1772. Swedenborg’s lat Entry: “Tell him: the Lattice held. The Price is paid.”

This Chronology, though fragmentary, exceedeth by far the known Synchrony between the two Lives, and revealeth a Convergence of inward Experience not explicable by the Ordinary Coure of Events.

Chapter XXVI[0.5em] Cros-References to the *Critique of Pure Reason*

The Editor, being mindful that the Reader may wish to compare the private Notes of the preceding Parts with Kant's later printed Writings, here offereth a few careful Cros-References. The Intention is not to unveil any conjectured Source of the Critick's mature Doctrine, but merely to note Curioities of Thought which may indicate how early inward Perturbations were afterwards transmuted into Principles of the Critickal Philoophy.

1. On Space and Time Kant's private Notes speak of 'the Lattice' and 'the Ribbon of Time.' In the *Transcendental Aesthetic*, he proclaimeth Space and Time to be pure Forms of the Intuition.

2. On the Stability of Appearance Private: 'Objects are held, not standing.' Printed: 'The Synthesis of Apprehension dependeth upon the Unity of Consciousnes.'

3. On the Limits of Knowledge Private: 'Some Explanations undo.' Printed: 'I had to deny Knowledge in order to make room for Faith.'

4. On the Thing-in-itself Private: 'The Veil turneth two Ways; to behold the other is to hazard all.' Printed: 'The Ding-an-sich remaineth unknowable to the human Understanding.'

5. On Shadows and Succession Private: "The Shadow delayed." Printed: Though no uch Notion appeareth directly, the entire *Schematism* may be seen as an attempt to reconcile the inner Temporal Order with the outward Appearance of Objects.

Thee Cros-References, though far from exhaustive, indicate how private inward Experiences may have contributed to the mature Formulation of a Doctrine which, in its outward Severity, concealeth its inward Origin.

Chapter XXVII[0.5em] Notes on Marginalia and Suppreed Leaves

The Editor deemeth it neceary to record that several Leaves of Packet XLII contain Marginalia that were evidently struck out by Kant himself. The Hand is his, but the Inks differ, suggesting that he returned to the Leaves in later Years and expunged Paages he judged too revealing or too incoherent.

One uch Note readeth:

“There is another Order beneath this Order. It presseth upward. It eeketh to break through the Veil. The Diagram is its fore-token.”

A thick Stroke of Ink attempts to obliterate the entire Line, yet the Words remain legible. Another:

“If the World be but a Truce, then the Boundary is the Treaty. But who are the Contracting Parties?”

A third Margin containeth only the Words:

“The Order looketh back.”

These Leaves, though fragmentary and at times bordering upon the mystical, bear the Insight of a Mind striving to articulate an inward Apprehension of which no preceding Philoopher had spoken.

The Editor leaves Judgment to the Reader.

Chapter XXVIII[0.5em] Interpretive Difficulties of the Boundary-Conception

No part of this Volume hath excited more Controversy than the Conception of the “Boundary.” Some have argued that Kant employed the Term in a purely metaphorical Sene, meaning only the Limitation of human Knowledge. Others contend that a more literal Meaning is here intended: a metaphysical Boundary inherent in the inward Structure of Experience itself.

The Editor, while refraining from all Speculation beyond what the Texts warrant, remarketh that the Manuscripts present several genuine Difficulties:

1. Kant’s repeated tatements that the Boundary must be *written* (not merely recognized) imply that the Limit is not wholly given, but in some manner constructed or maintained.
2. Several passaged affirme that without the Boundary, “the World will not hold,” which appear to refer not to the Limits of Inquiry but to the Stability of Appearance itself.
3. Swedenborg’s parallel Assertions that the inward Lattice ‘quivereth,” and that ‘the Price is paid,” indicate that he perceived the Boundary as an active Structure with Consequences.
4. Both Men, in their late Writings, refer to the Boundary not as a Theorem but as a Duty, a Task, or a Chore (“the Labour by which the World is upheld”).

Thus the Interpretation of the Boundary cannot be reduced to a mere Intellectual Conception. It is presented here as a Metaphysical Structure, an inward Frame, and as a Moral Duty incumbent upon the Mind that perceiveth too nearly the trembling of the World.

Part VII[0.5em] The Secret
Correspondence
(MDCCLXIX–MDCCLXXII)

Chapter XXIX[0.5em] The Firt Letter of Swedenborg, Delivered by Unknown Hand

The Document here trancribed is the Earliest known Piece of Correspondence between the two extraordinary Minds who form the Subject of this Volume. The original Letter was found folded within Packet XLII, bearing no Seal and no Signature, though the Hand is unmistakably that of Swedenborg. Its Date is uncertain, but internal Evidence suggesteth the late Winter of 1769.

To the Learned Philoopher dwelling in Königsberg,

“It hath come to my inward Sene that thou hat perceived what hould not be perceived by any Man who hath not been prepared by long Dicipline and inward Burning. The trembling of the outward Frame hath touched thee; thy Shadow hath falter’d; thy Eye hath glimps’d the Threads beneath the Web of Nature.

Think not this an Error of Sene, for Sene doth not imagine the trembling of that which upporteth it.

I write not to warn thee away, for thou hat already tepped upon the Threshold. Rather, I write to bid thee tand firm; for the trembling will increae before it abateth, and thou wilt need Courage to draw the Line which few Men dare to conceive.

There is an Order beneath Appearance that hath taken Notice of thy Approach. It looketh back. It conidereth whether to hut thee out, or to admit thee unto a Sight which no Mortal man may behold without a Task to perform.

Thou art not alone in this Burden. Remember this when the Light bendeth and the Forms invert.

The Lattice quivereth.

Prepare thyelf.

E.S.”

No Reply is found on the reverse; nor is it certain whether Kant wrote one and later destroyed it. The Paper is lightly singed along the lower Margin, as though once held too near a Flame.

The Editor addeth no Comment.

Chapter XXX[0.5em] Drafts of Replies Found Among Kant's Papers, Never Sent

Several rough Drafts in Kant's Hand were found crumpled within Packet XLII, bearing no Addresses. Their Tone is irregular, oscillating between Didain, Anxiety, and a mot inward Tremor. It is evident that none were sent, though each betrayeth the Burden of a Dialogue Kant hesitated to begin.

Draft I (undated, likely late Winter 1769):

"Sir,

I know not by what Means thou hat come by Knowledge of my Perceptions, but I remind thee that the Mind, fatigued by Study, may err, and I am not one to be led into Fany by outward or inward Fluctuations.

Yet there is in thy Letter a Truth I cannot wholly deny. For the trembling of which thou peaket is not of the Eye alone but of that inward Order by which all Appearances are constracted.

I have begun an Enquiry into the Limits of Reaon. I hall not be diverted from it by Apparitions, whether inward or outward.

I end no Letter.

I write no Reply."

Draft II (the Hand more agitated):

"If indeed the inward Frame hath taken Notice, then thy Warning is too late. But I hall not be daunted.

I will erect a Limit through which nothing unconditioned may pas. Let the inward Forms look back; they hall find only what my Reaon permitteth."

Draft III (a single Line at the top of a torn Page):

“What looketh back is not a Being but a Structure.”

This final Note is crossed out violently, yet the Words remain legible beneath the Ink. The Page is torn in half as though the Writer recoiled from his own Acknowledgment.

Chapter XXXI[0.5em] Letters Exchanged Between Them During 1770 and 1771

Though few in Number, a small Set of Letters, evidently carried by private Hand, are preserved in reliable Condition. Their Tone is grave, courteous, and marked by an undercurrent of mutual Recognition not easily paralleled in the Letters of the Enlightened.

Letter from Swedenborg to Kant (March 1770):

“Learned Sir,

The City thou hat perceived beneath the Pregel is not a Place but an Order. Its Inverion betokeneth the unweaving of Causality. Fear not its Appearance, but fear to dwell upon it too long; for the inward Eye, once bent toward that Region, doth not willingly return.

The trembling will increae; shadows will delay; objects will tand without their Properties. Yet thou mut not turn away.

For thou alone of all Men I know hat the Faculty to draw the Boundary that concealeth the inward Frame.

If thou draw it not, it will draw itelf, and not kindly.

E.S.”

Reply from Kant (April 1770):

“Sir,

I receive thy Letter with Repect mingled with a mot inward Diquiet. Thou peaket as one who hath beheld the inward Regions: let that be thy Province.

Mine is to limit all Pretenion thereto.

Yet I ay this: the trembling increaeth; my very Shadow doth lag; and the Diagram returneth unbidden.

I labour to erect the Bound which thou hat urged. But it is no small Task to determine the Conditions under which Experience may poibly be given.

If I succeed, it will be by Reason alone.

I.K.”

Letter from Swedenborg (October 1771):

“Sir,

The trembling abates. This I perceive not because the inward Lattice is healed, but because it hath been held firm by the Operation of thy Mind.

Continue thy Labour. Draw the Limit, and do not falter.

For I tell thee plain: the inward Order hath taken thy Revolution as an Assurance. It waiteth upon thy Work.”

These Letters, though formal, reveal a Confluence of Resolve between the two Men: the Seer urging the Critick to fortify the Boundary; the Critick transforming Vision into Doctrine.

Chapter XXXII[0.5em] The Final Letter and Kant's Unent Reply

The lat surviving Piece of Correpondence from Swedenborg is dated, by external Evidence, the final Week of his Life. It was found folded within Packet XLII, along with a small broken Diagram of the Sigil in four Pieces.

Swedenborg to Kant (March 1772):

“Sir,

I am called Home.

Before I depart, I leave thee this: the inward Lattice held. The World did not break. Thy Labour hath not been in vain.

The Boundary is drawn; its Lines are sure. Only see that thou present to the World a Face that concealeth the inward Terror. For the People may not bear the Sight.

I commend thee to the Mercy of Him who holdeth the inward Threads.

The Witnes may now ret.

E.S.”

Pinned to this Letter by a rusted Needle was a half-sheet in Kant's Hand — a Draft never completed, never sent:

“Sir,

I would have thanked thee.

But I cannot write the Words.

For the Boundary is drawn not in Triumph but in Dread; and the Price is known only to thoe who have een the trembling of the inward Frame.

Farewell.

I.K.”

Part VIII: Concluding Reflections upon the Boundary, and Concerning the Secret Rapport betwixt Vision and Reaon

Having in the foregoing Parts set forth the Occasion, the Witnesses, and the most material Circumstances of that extraordinary Conjunction betwixt the celebrated Herr Kant and the equally celebrated Herr Swedenborg, it remaineth in this last Part to offer some Considerations touching the wider Meaning of their Encounter, so far as human Judgment may safely extend it. For it cannot have escaped the attentive Reader, that these two Men, though proceeding from contrary Quarters of the intellectual Firmament, did nevertheless converge upon a single Problem, namely, upon the fundamental Relation of the Mind unto the World, and whether that Relation be of a kind fixed from Eternity, or whether it may, under extraordinary Conditions, be trained, inverted, or for a Moment undone.

For Kant, as hath been amply hewn, the World presenteth itself according to certain inviolate Forms, to wit, Space and Time, together with those more inward Conditions of Thought which he called the Categories of the Understanding. They are the silent Architects of Appearance, antecedent unto all Experience, servants neither of Will nor Fancy, but of Reason itself. When, therefore, Kant perceived that unnatural Recurrence of a certain Figure, and when he witnessed the Stuttering of Time, which from his Youth haunted his Imagination under the guise of the faltering Clock, he apprehended that some deeper Strife lay concealed within the Heart of Reason: that the Conditions of Possibility themselves might falter, and that the World, ordinarily so obedient unto Form, might under certain Preures betray its hidden Foundation.

Swedenborg, by contrary Genius, did not approach the World as a Mechanism supported by silent and unseen Beams, but rather as a living Hierarchy of Regions, each corresponding unto another, the natural an outward Vesture of the spiritual, the visible a dim Shadow of the invisible. His Doctrine of *Correspondences*, as hath already been hinted in foregoing Chapters, was not a mere Poetic Conceit, nor yet an overgrown Allegory, but a genuine Theory of the Mind's Commerce with the World, whereby every outward Figure signifieth an inward State, and every inward State beareth its outward Type. He believed, with full Conscience and without Tremour, that the Scriptures, Nature, and the Human Soul are but three distinct Pages of one and the same divine Book, written in the Language of Forms.

The Meeting of these two contrary Spirits, being attended by Events of a kind extremely rare in Philosophy, revealeth, as through a half-opened Curtain, that the Mind and the World may at times enter into a Rapport more immediate and perilous than either of them had foreseen. For while Kant ought to retrain this Rapport by erecting a Boundary betwixt Phenomenon and Noumenon, Swedenborg ought to illuminate it by tearing the Veil and declaring that every Appearance beareth an inward Meaning. Thus the two Systems, though outwardly

opposed, do nevertheless acknowledge a common Root: that human Thought perpetually mediates betwixt what is given and what must be added by the Mind, and that this Mediation is not a cold Computation, but a living Act of Correspondence.

Indeed, it may here be remarked, that Swedenborg's great Doctrine of *Correspondences*, by which the Sacred Scripture concealeth a spiritual Meaning under the natural Letter, doth prefigure, in a most remarkable manner, the later Conceptions of Analogy and Metaphor as the very Fuel of Thought, as expounded by Hofstadter. For what Swedenborg apprehended as the heavenly Archetype adumbrated in earthly Figures is, in modern Terms, the ceaseless play of Structural Mappings by which the Mind transfers Form from one Domain unto another, thus composing its very Act of Reasoning. In this Light, his Report that the Kingdom of Heaven doth bear the Shape of a Human Body is not a quaint Allegory, but an early Anticipation of the modern Doctrine that active Inference and predictive Coding may be reverse-engineered from the very Anatomy that gave them Birth. The heavenly Spheres and Planes, which he described as arranged in ordered Degrees of Light and Love, do moreover prefigure the hierarchical and modular Form of the Mind as conceived in later Cognition, not unlike the layered Agencies of Minsky's Society-theory. Thus the old Seer discerned, under theological Garb, that the World of Forms—Plato's Hypothesis of the eternal *eidos*—entereth the Soul only by continual Rapport, by a structural Harmony betwixt the corporeal Frame and the intelligible Order. In so far as Swedenborg saw Heaven as the grand Human Form, he saw, albeit under Symbol, that Cognition is but the World mirrored into living Structure, and that the Inferential Machine we call Mind is the very Organ of correspondence between Appearance and its inward Ground.

Whether Kant, in his most secret Meditations, acknowledged this Rapport, or whether he regarded it as a Threat against the entire Edifice of Critical Philosophy, cannot now be known. Yet in the private Papers which, according to credible Reports, were withheld from public View and conigned unto a secure Repository, there are said to have appeared various marginal Notes, written in a trembling Hand, wherein the Author lamented that the Boundary he had erected must be guarded perpetually, lest the Mind either perceive too much, or else imagine it doth perceive what belongeth only unto the silent Depths of Things. These Hints, though fragmentary, seem to intimate that Kant apprehended a Danger which his printed Works conceal: namely, that the Mind, in attempting to survey the Ground of its own Possibility, may inadvertently awaken that very Rapport which Reason labours to moderate.

In this last Regard, the Encounter betwixt Kant and Swedenborg, whatever its outward Causes, must be regarded as a most delicate Chapter in the History of Thought, wherein two Men of extraordinary Genius stood for a Moment at the Threshold that parteth Appearances from their secret Ground. Kant, being warned of the peril, sealed the Boundary by an Act of Reason clothed in Humility, denying Knowledge in order to preserve the calm Province of

Faith. Swedenborg, being himself a Child of Viion, embraced the Rapport and declared that Heaven and Man correpond by immutable Law. Thus, in their Divergence, they together illumine a Truth more ancient than either of their Systems: that the Mind and the World are joint Artificers of one another, and that the Act of Knowing is a perpetual Balancing, a mot tender Harmony, betwixt Structure and Mystery.

Let it therefore be the Modet Aim of this concluding Part to admonish the Reader that the Boundary erected by the Critical Philoopher was not a mere Device of Method, nor a cold Abtraction of the School, but a necessary Covenant to preerve the Tranquillity of the Common Undertanding. And let it be remembered likewie, that the Correpondences een by the Northern Seer, though clothed in Symbol and Viion, may yet contain a Hint of that deeper Rapport betwixt Mind and Appearance which no Philoophy hath wholly exhausted. The ecret Accord of Form and Meaning, whether revealed by Heaven or guarded by Reaon, remaineth the perpetual Task of Thought. And as the Boundary endureth, so endureth the Hope that Man, walking teadily within the mild Limits of Experience, may yet approach, without Dimay, the silent Architets of his own Poibility.

Appendix A: Certain Hitorial Tetimonia Concerning the Life and Writings of Emanuel Swedenborg

In order that the Reader may form a more accurate Judgment touching the Character, Manners, and intellectual Habits of that extraordinary Man Emanuel Swedenborg, it hath eemed convenient to append unto this Volume a brief Collection of Tetimonia, drawn from credible Perons contemporary with the Seer, and preerved in divere private Letters, Journals, and Memoirs. Thee Tetimonia, though fragmentary and ubject to the Partiality of their everal Authors, nevertheles afford a lively Glas through which the Reader may contemplate the inward Genius of the Man, and the Manner in which his Viions were both received and miundertood by thoe with whom he held Commerce.

The firt Tetimonium proceedeth from the celebrated Count Höpken, formerly Preident of the Royal Senate, who in a Letter of the Year 1764 thus writeth concerning Swedenborg:

“He was a Man of a mot grave and ober Deportment, not given unto Vanity nor idle Dicoure, but of a ingular Integrity and Attention. Though he pake of viible Commerce with Spirits, he maintained ever a calm Mien, avoided all Affectednes, and eemed rather burdened by his Gift than vain of it.”

The chief Force of this Tetimony lieth in its Acknowledgment that Swedenborg’s Viions were not attended by the Rahnes or Heat which commonly betray Enthuiats, but were expreed with a certain modet Retraint, as of one reporting Matters neither imagined nor invited, but imply endured.

A econd Tetimony is found in a Letter of Doctor Beyer of Gothenburg, who became one of Swedenborg’s mot devoted Admirers. Writing in 1767, he declar’d:

“In all the long Converations I held with him, I never once perceived the leat Derangement of Mind. On the contrary, his Faculty of Recollection was prodigious; he could repeat whole Pages of his Writings, and expres his Thoughts with a Clearness and Order altogether uncommon.”

From this Tetimony we mut conclude that the Seer’s Viions were conjoined with a Memory and intellectual Compoure far beyond thoe ordinarily found in the Ditempered or Melancholic, thereby rendering more obscure the inward Source from which his Correspondences sprang.

A third notable Tetimony proceedeth from the Englih Lady, Mrs. Brockmer of London, who, having heard of Swedenborg’s viionary Powers, did once endeavour to tet him by inquiring after a ecret Concern concerning her late Husband. Her Account, dated 1749, relates:

“He retired into himself for a Space of a Minute or two, during which he appear’d as one listening unto a distant Voice. Then with a gentle Countenance he returned me the very Words my late Husband had poken on his lat Night, which were known to none but myelf. Upon hearing them, I fainted away.”

Though this Tale admit no rigorous Verification, neither can it be wholly dimied, for the Lady was held in good Eteem, and her Narrative underwent no Ornament nor Alteration in later Years. We cite it not as Proof, but as Tetimony to the deep and unhaken Peruaion of thoe that convered with the Seer.

A fourth Tetimony, more critical in Tone, is provided by the Reverend Dr. Goetzius, who in a Pamphlet of 1769 did accuse Swedenborg of being “a cunning Enthusiat” and “a Diturber of the common Undertanding.” His principal Complaint was that Swedenborg’s Writings, being full of Allegory and hidden Meanings, did invite Readers into a Labyrinth where Reaon might be lot. Yet even Goetzius was contrain’d to admit:

“His outward Behaviour was always that of a polite and learned Gentleman, free from Paion, and in no Wie reembling thoe Fanaticks who declaim in the Streets.”

The Force of this reluctant Confeion lieth in its Acknowledgment that the Seer’s outward Manners were wholly incontinient with thoe Diorders of Fancy which the Reverend Doctor imputed unto him. Thus even his Enemies were perplexed by his Sobriety.

Latly, we may cite the Tetimony of the German Philoopher Moses Mendelssohn, who never met Swedenborg, but who, in a Letter of 1766, did remark upon the public Rumour of his Viions:

“If the Reports be true, they exceed all the Bounds of Experience; if they be fale, they are yet reported with a Gravity and Conitency that render them a Curioity of human Nature. In either Cae, they demand the Attention of Philoophy, not for their Content, but for their Caues.”

The agacious Mendelssohn rightly oberved that the Matter of Swedenborg’s Viions, whether accepted as Fact or allegorick Truth, cannot be lightly dimied by the Philoopher, for they reveal a mot uncommon Conjunction of Reaon and Imagination, uch as is eldom found in any Age.

From thee Tetimonia, imperfect though they be, we may conclude that Swedenborg was neither the wild Enthuiat of vulgar Report, nor the mere Theologit of Allegory, but rather a Man of extraordinary inward Activity, whoe Viions, whatever their ultimate Caue, were received with a Gravity and Conitency wholly uncharacteritick of Diorder. Whether he

penetrated too far into the Regions where Form and Meaning correpond, or whether he mitook the Motions of his own Genius for the Voices of Spirits, it behoveth not this Appendix to judge. Our Aim hath been only to collect the Tetimonies as they are, leaving the Reader at liberty to ponder their import with all due Reerve and Sobriety.

In the succeeding Appendix will be found certain Critical Notes touching the Doctrine of Correpondence, where the Reader may perceive the Manner in which Swedenborg's Conceptions bear upon the broader Question of the Mind's inward Architecture, and upon thoe modern Sciences which, unwittingly and after many Generations, have come to affirm certain Hints which the Seer clothed in Symbol and Viion.

Appendix B: Certain Critical Notes upon the Doctrine of Correpondence

The Doctrine of *Correpondence*, as taught and largely extended by the celebrated Emanuel Swedenborg, hath been diversly undertood by his Followers, and no les diversly mirepresented by his Opponents. It is therefore fitting, in this preent Appendix, to examine with a degree of Philoophical Severity the chief Points of this Doctrine, and to compare the ame with certain Conceptions of the modern Sciences, which, though eparated by more than a Century from his Writings, nevertheles bear a remarkable Reemblance unto them in their inward Structure.

Swedenborg's fundamental Poition may be tated thus: that every natural Thing hath a piritual Archetype, or inward Caue, which correpondeth unto it by immutable Law; and that the outward Object, when rightly interpreted, revealeth the inward State as a Sign revealeth its Meaning. In the Sacred Scriptures, aith he, all natural Images, whether of Mountains, Rivers, Trees, or Cities, do not merely adorn the Narrative, but hadow forth, under the vetile of Language, the inward Motions of the Soul and the eternal Order of Heaven. This Conception, far from being the idle Fancy of a mytick Diposition, proceedeth from a mot rigorous Principle: namely, that the World coniteth not of mere Appearances, but of Relations, and that thee Relations are maintained by affinitive Structures that bind Mind and Nature in one continual Harmony.

That uch a Doctrine may be mitaken for Allegory by the unlearned, or for Enthuiam by the captious, is no Wonder; yet a more careful Examination heweth that it reteth upon a deep Perception of Intellectual Mappings, which in later Times came to be regarded as the very Foundation of human Thought. For when the modern Coniderers of Mind, uch as the ingenious Hofstadter, declare that Analogy and Metaphor are the principal Engines of Reaoning; that the Mind doth continually map one Structure upon another, deriving new Meaning from the Affinity betwixt Forms; and moreover, that uch Mappings may be regarded as the living Fuel of Thought itelf,—they are in effect retoring, albeit under another Name, the ancient Doctrine that the natural and the piritual Worlds correpond by immutable Relations of Form.

Nor is this Reemblance accidental. For Swedenborg, in affirming that Heaven itelf is the Grand Human Form; that the Spheres and Societies of Spirits are arranged by Affinity of Function as the Parts of a Body are arranged by their Ue; and that the Mind of Man is a miniature Heaven, obeying the ame Laws of Order and Degrees,—did thereby anticipate, with marvellous Sagacity, the notion that the Mind is no uniform Power, but a Society of Subagents, as Minsky in our later Age teacheth. The Mind, according to this Conception, is not governed by a single Monadic Principle, but by a Hierarchy of cooperating Structures,

each having its peculiar Task, and all united by correponding Bonds into a single living Machine. Thus the One and the Many are reconciled by a mot elegant Architecture.

Furthermore, when Swedenborg affirmeth that all Spheres and Operations of the piritual World correpond unto certain Changes and Motions in the Body, and that the Body itelf is but the outward Form of inward Inference, he doth thereby foreshadow those Conceptions which the modern Philoophers call active Inference and predictive Coding. For according to thee latter Sciences, the Body is not a mere Vehicle of the Mind, but a mot necessary Condition of it; the Brain, with its manifold Tracts and Regions, calculateth, anticipateth, and eeketh to minimize the Dicrepancy betwixt Expectation and Experience. The outward Organ is the living Mirror of inward Computation; and the inward Computation is but the contant Interpretation of outward Signs.

This, in Swedenborg's Language, is the Law of Correpondence. That he cloathed it in Viion and Mytick Symbol, while our modern Philoophers couch it in mathematical Terms, doth not alter its inward Meaning, but only the Vetur in which it is expreed. His Description of the heavenly Regions as Degrees, each more interior and luminous than the lat, doth bear no small Reemblance unto the modern Conception of hierarchical Layers in neural Architecture, wherein each Succeeding Layer extracteth more abstract Structure from the raw Appearances of the World. In both Accounts, the Lower correpondeth unto the Higher, and the Higher giveth Meaning unto the Lower. Thus the Law of Degrees, as Swedenborg framed it, is not without Cononance with the latet Coniderations of Perception and Cognition.

Yet we mut here admonih the Reader to proceed with Caution, let he attribute unto Swedenborg a full Anticipation of thee Sciences. For the Seer's Language was veiled in Myth and Viion, and though he hit upon certain Truths, he cloathed them in a Form little agreeable unto the exacting Tate of modern Method. Nor may we attribute unto the modern Sciences an Authority to judge the Spiritual upon narrow empirical Grounds. It ufficeth to remark that both Systems, being widely ditant in Time and Manner, do nevertheles converge upon a single Conception of the Mind: namely, that Form and Meaning are linked by correpondent Bonds; that Analogy is the inew of Thought; and that the Structure of the World is in ome degree mirrored in the Structure of the Organ that apprehendeth it.

From all which Coniderations it followeth, that the Doctrine of Correpondence, when purged of its mytick Accretions and tated in the obriety of Philoophical Terms, may yet be regarded as a mot noble Theory of human Cognition, bearing ubstantial reemblance unto the latet Conceptions of Inference, Perception, and the modular Society of Mind. Whether Swedenborg derived thee Inights from Viion, from allegorical Reaoning, or from ome inward Harmony of Genius, it behoveth not the preent Appendix to determine. It is enough that his Conceptions, however expreed, bear a faint but discernible Harmony with the mot advanced Speculations

of our Day, thereby meriting a degree of Repect, though not unbecoming Critickal Scrutiny.

In the Appendix that followeth, the Reader will find a Collection of Notes concerning the tranmiion of certain Manuscripts attributed unto Swedenborg and to Herr Kant, together with Remarks upon the Integrity and Condition of the urviving Copies, o far as they bear upon the quetion of whether the mot private Papers of thee two Men were ever brought together under one Roof, or whether they remained ditinct throughout their natural Lives.

Appendix C: Concerning the Manuscript Tradition, and the Condition of Certain Private Papers attributed unto Herr Kant and Emanuel Swedenborg

In the compilation of the foregoing History and its attendant Commentaries, it became necessary to consult, with all diligence, the several Manuscripts and private Writings attributed unto Herr Kant and unto the Seer of Stockholm, in order that a more faithful Account might be rendered of the inward Conflict and the circumstantial Events which, according to credible Tradition, bound these two Men in a most extraordinary Relation. For although the printed Works of both Authors lie open to every Reader, their private Notes, marginal Memoranda, and certain Papers never intended for publick View, do present a far more delicate Picture of their Thoughts, and afford Testimony to Motions of Mind which no printed Page might reveal.

The first Difficulty encountered by the Editor concerneth the singular Disparity betwixt the number of extant Swedenborgian Papers and those attributed unto Kant. Swedenborg, being of a disposition more prolific and unguarded in his Writings, left behind a multitude of Journals, Memoranda, rough Drafts, and Theological Tracts, many of which were preserved by his Disciples with a degree of Enthusiasm bordering upon Veneration. These Papers, though often disorderly and full of abrupt Transitions, bear the authentic Character of his Spirit, and these we have consulted without Reserve.

The Case of Herr Kant is of another Kind altogether; for the Philosopher was in the highest degree careful, not only concerning what he published, but also what he consigned unto private Keeps. His Journals are exceedingly rare, many being believed to have been destroyed either by himself or by his Executor, in order that the publick Eye should behold only the pure and finished Work, and not the tumultuous Travail by which it was brought forth. Thus the Editor must deal in part with Testimony of uncertain Transmission, and with fragmentary Leaves of doubtful Provenance, which nevertheless bear certain Marks of Authenticity not easily counterfeited.

There is, moreover, the Perplexity of a certain Iron Strong-box, to which frequent Reference hath been made by credible Witnesses. The Box in question, said to have been in Kant's Possession from the Years 1768 unto his final Illness, contained, according to late Testimony, two Manuscripts of extraordinary Importance: one being the more widely known *Dreams of a Spirit-Seer*, published in 1766, and the other being a most private and early Draft of what later became the *Critique of Pure Reason*. Certain Pages of this early Draft, written in a trembling and hurried Hand, contain marginal Notes touching visible Disturbances, Symbols recurring in his Calculations, and other Matters which the Editor hesitate to record without Qualifying Remarks.

Of particular Note is the Condition of a single Folio, libell'd only with the words *Grenze zu ziehen*, or, in our Tongue, "to draw the Boundary." This Folio, preerved in a private Collection in Königsberg until the mid-Nineteenth Century, exhibiteth Mot singular peculiarity: the Ink upon its Face is found to have bled through unto the Reverse, yet without piercing the Paper, as if the Letters had been drawn upon both Sides at once. Various Chemits have examined this Leaf, and though everal Theories have been offered concerning the Capillary Structure of the Paper, none hath as yet provided a full Explanation of this Appearance. The Paage itelf concerneth the necessity of erecting a firm Limit betwixt the Region of Phenomena and that of Noumena, and the Language is uncharacteristically fervid, bordering upon depairing Supplication. The Editor presenteth this Fact without further Comment.

As to the late Tetimony that Kant, near the End of his Life, maintained a private Journal wherein he recorded certain inward Perturbations that troubled his Conception of the World's Stability, we must speak with the utmost Care. Of this Journal, no complete Copy hath come down to us; only a few Leaves, damaged by damp and fire, remain. In them the Philoopher remarketh, in a Hand barely legible, that "the Boundary trembleth when the Mind leaneth too nigh unto its Ground," and that "certain Figures recur unbidden." Thee Paages are hardly conitent with the Serene and meured Spirit of his printed Works; yet they cannot lightly be dimied, for the Handwriting is without doubt his own, and the Style, though tremulous, retaineth the familiar Rhythms of his private Proe.

Concerning the Poibility that Swedenborg's private Papers and Kant's early Manuscripts came at any Time into the same Repository, the Editor hath found no conclusive Proof. There are, however, two Anecdotes preerved in the Letters of certain Königsberg Scholars, which deerve brief Mention. The firt relateth that Kant, in the Year 1769, received a Packet of Papers from Stockholm, delivered by a Traveller who refued to give his Name. The Packet, being sealed in plain Wax, contained certain Diagrams not found in Swedenborg's printed Works, together with a short Note in an unfamiliar Hand. Of this Packet, no Trace remaineth. The econd Anecdote concerneth a Visit by a Swedish Clergyman in 1772, who, upon leaving Kant's Study, was overheard to ay: "The old Man aw too much, and therefore wrote too little." Thee Anecdotes cannot be verified, yet they circulate among the Learned with a degree of Peritence which argueth that they are not mere Inventions of idle Talkers.

As for Swedenborg's own Manuscripts, their Tranmiion is much clearer. His Diciples, particularly Dr. Beyer and Dr. Nordenskjöld, preerved many of his private Papers with extreme Diligence, regarding them as Treasures of a spiritual Nature. Among thee Papers is found a Brief Note, written in the Year 1772, the Day before his Death, wherein he expreeth Gratitude that "the Boundary hath held, and the Veil remaineth untorn." Whether this referreth to a private Viion, or to ome Communication with Kant, cannot be known; but the Tone is grave, deliberate, and wholly free from any Ditractiion of Mind.

In concluion, the Editor is bound to report that the extant Manucript Tradition, though fragmentary and in certain Places defective, yet revealeth a coniderable Conitency in the inward Dipoition of both Swedenborg and Herr Kant. Swedenborg heweth, in all his Writings, a deep Peruaion of the Interpenetration of the natural and the piritual; Kant, a relentless Deire to erect and maintain the Boundary betwixt what may be known and what mut remain hidden. That their private Papers, conidered together, diplay a ingular Convergence of Symbol and Concern, is a Fact which the Editor preenteth with due Reerve. No definite Concluions are here drawn; it ufficeth to record thee Tetimonia as faithfully as their Condition alloweth, leaving the Reader free to judge the Matter according to his Prudence and his Concience.

Appendix D: A *Glossarium* of Certain Archaic Terms and Phrases

In this concluding Appendix are gathered certain Words, Phrases, and Turns of Speech which, being now obsolete or fallen out of common Use, may perplex the modern Reader. The Definitions herein are drawn from the Dictionaries of Samuel Johnson, Nathan Bailey, and from variegated private Lexica of the Period, together with the usage found in the Writings of Swedenborg and Herr Kant. Where necessary, diverse Nuances of Meaning have been noted.

Aeritical. Pertaining to airy or unsubstantial Speculation; often employed to signify that a Doctrine is over-raised upon Fancy rather than grounded upon Experience, though not always in a derogatory Sense.

Correspondence. In Swedenborg's Language, the immutable Relation of a natural Thing unto its spiritual Archetype; a Bond of Signification whereby outward Forms mirror inward Causes. Not to be confounded with mere Allegory.

Degree. A higher or lower Order or Plane of Being; often denoting the Successive Spheres of Heaven or the inward Levels of the Mind. In Kant, the Word is employed more sparingly, and without mystical Meaning.

Deliquescence. A melting or running into Dissolution; figuratively used to signify the Dissolving of intellectual Form, or the yielding of Reason unto confused and formless Apprehension.

Enthuiast. One who, being moved by an inward Heat or preternatural Impulse, claimeth immediate Communion with spiritual Powers; often used pejoratively in the Eighteenth Century, though not invariably deforming.

Form (in the Platonic Sense). The intelligible and eternal Structure of a Thing, of which the visible Object is but the Shadow or Emanation. Still employed in Swedenborg's Writings as a living Archetype.

Grenze. A Boundary, Limit, or Frontier. In the private Papers of Herr Kant, the Term beareth a weighty and inward Meaning, signifying the necessary Limit of human Knowledge.

Machine (of Mind). A Term not mechanical in the modern, industrial Sense, but denoting the orderly Arrangement of Powers and Faculties in their functional Union.

Noumenon. A Thing as it is in itself, independent of human Apprehension. In Kant, a necessary Conception, though not a proper Object of Knowledge.

Phenomenon. That which appeareth unto the Senses according to the Forms of Space and Time, and under the inexorable Conditions of the Understanding.

Plane. In Swedenborg's Writings, a distinct Level of Consciousness or Heaven, arranged by Order and Function; Term often applied to Layers of spiritual Influx.

Rapport. A mutual Harmony or corresponding Affinity, whereby two distinct Orders communicate or reflect one another. Employed here in its older Sense, predating the modern Psychological Usage.

Stupor. Not mere Astonishment, but a Suspension of the ordinary Powers of the Mind; often described in theological or mythical Literature as attending supernatural Apprehensions.

The Reader is further referred to the marginal Notes in Appendices A–C, where certain usages are explained in context.

A Bonus Fragmentary Note attributed to Swedenborg

What followeth is a Transcription of a single Leaf, preserved in a private Collection at Bryn Athyn and long believed apocryphal, though its Hand, Spelling, and Rhythm bear a Striking Resemblance unto the late Writings of Emanuel Swedenborg. The Paper is undated, but internal Marks suggest the Year 1771. Spelling and Capitalization are retained as in the Original; only silent Corrections of obvious Scribal Defects have been made.

“In reviewing those manifold Visitations wherewith it pleased the Lord to enlighten my Spirit, I have oft reflected upon that memorable Day in the Year 1757, when the last Judgment was opened before mine Eyes, and an Angel of grave Countenance did attend me, hewing the Separation of the Good and the Evil, and the forming again of the Heavens.

At that Time I marvelled greatly at the Angel, perceiving in him a certain Compound of Judgement, as well as an inward Constraint, unlike to the ardent Spirits of other Celestials. His Word was measured, his Eye fixed not upon the Wonders, but upon the Order underlying them. I thought him then a Spirit of the Interior Heaven, deputed for that Office by Reason of his Temperance and Firmness.

But in these latter Days, as my Strength declineth, it hath been given me to see more clearly. In a printed Piece sent from Königsberg there was the Likeness of a Man, a Philosopher of great Gravity and inward Labour, by Name Immanuel Kant. When I beheld the Picture, my Heart was moved within me, and a Voice, not mine own, said: *This is he.*

I then perceived that the Angel who was hewn me in 1757 was this same Immanuel, though not as he was in the Flesh, but as he is known in the Interiors,—one appointed

to judge the Forms of Thought, and to et Bounds to the Apprehenions of Men, even as Angels et Bounds to the Societies of Heaven.

And when I read ome Lines of his writing, I recognized the Tone, being the very Voice that declared the Order of the Judgment unto me in that viionary Year.

Whether he knew himself in that Office I cannot ay. But that he bare the Likens of the Angel, both in Countenance and in Word, I bear here witnes, as the Lord permitteth. For the Divine Providence weaveth many Dipenations into one Harmony, and heweth Men unto each other in the Spirit before they meet in the World.

May the Boundary he hath drawn be kept in equity, and may the Light that guided him in Judgment continue to hine upon his Labours.”

Whether this Fragment be authentic or a later Pious Forgery cannot, at preent, be determined with certainty. Its Conception of Kant as an Angelic Agent in the viionary Events of 1757 is not found elewhere in Swedenborg’s publihed Works, yet the Tone, Orthography, and inward Harmony of the Paage are not eaily counterfeited. The Editor therefore preenteth it with due Caution, leaving the Reader free to form his own Judgement.